



NETWORK ENGINEER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Network engineers set up and maintain the networks that carry information between computers. These networks use a range of technologies to work.

They may connect computers located either in a single office or computers separated by huge distances. Network engineers also diagnose and fix problems with network software and check the cables, radio links, and even satellites that carry the information. They also provide on-site help to a company's staff.

SALARY

Junior network engineer ★★☆☆☆

Senior network engineer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Growing job market • Opportunities available in almost every area of business or industry • Opportunities to work in-house or on a freelance basis for external consultancies



CAREER PATHS

Career progress as a network engineer depends on the type and size of the company you work for. If the company is small, you will be called upon to deal with a variety of computer issues, from slow Internet speeds to virus infections. However, if you work for a large global company, you are more likely to specialize in one particular area, such as network architecture or cybersecurity.

TRAINEE A person with a good general education and strong Information Technology (IT) skills may find work as a trainee technician. On-the-job learning and taking college-level courses may put you on the path to becoming a network engineer.

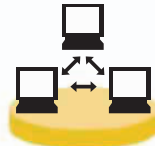


GRADUATE If you have an undergraduate or graduate degree in computer science or systems engineering, you can find work with companies that run large and complex networks.



NETWORK ARCHITECT

Designs an organization's computer network. This involves analyzing how the business works and planning a network that can meet its needs both now and in the future.



NETWORK ENGINEER The role requires continual learning to keep up to date with ever-changing technologies. You usually specialize in one or more networking systems made by different manufacturers.